

A WORD FOR THE WEARY

(The Gathering 2023)

All of us grow weary – All those engaged in a God Vision suffer from fatigue from time to time. (Joke about illness and fatigue – Sick and tired of going to work)

God knew that we would struggle with this emotion, which is why He tells us, “***Be not weary in well doing, for in DUE SEASON you shall REAP if you do not FAINT.***”

We have all heard the old adage, “*Rome wasn’t built in a day.*” This is so true, and nothing of significance gets built in a day. Please remember, Rome didn’t fall apart in a day either.

It is exhausting to think of all the attention it takes to detail, to build something of significance. (Just building a house takes months and includes thousands of details)

I am convinced that the weariness we suffer in ministry is not solely the result of being overworked (Though we are at times), and living under constant pressure (though we do – Ministry is 24/7). It is the result of:

- The spiritual battles we face...
- The physical challenges we encounter...
- The emotional toll that the journey generates...
- The relational trauma that can be inflicted along the way...

All of this to do what we believe to be the will of God. These ingredients are a constant, in the crock pot, of what God is cooking.

I have a **trivia question** for you guys. **Which building project took the longest to complete?**
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME AS I MENTION THEM)

A. The construction of the Pentagon

B. The carving of Mount Rushmore

C. The digging of the Panama Canal

D. The building of the Empire State Building

E. The carving and assembling of the Statue of Liberty

The answer is C - It took 31 years to dig the Panama Canal. The length of this project was mainly because the project was started and stopped several times due to floods, mudslides, and unexpected costs. The total bill for the United States was \$375 million in 1914 (In today's economy that would be almost 11 billion dollars).

The building of the Panama Canal resulted in the death of 20,000 French workers and 6,000 American workers.

The moral of the story - When you build a 50 mile-long canal that connects two oceans:

- Expect it to take longer than anticipated...

- Expect it to cost more than anticipated...
- Expect that some people who started with you not to be present when you finish...

The same is true of ministry – We are not attempting to move millions of tons of earth and connect two oceans, but the assignment He has called us to, can be mind boggling – emotionally draining – and absolutely exhausting.

If we don't feel overwhelmed at times by the task at hand, we are probably focused on the wrong goal.

We can't accomplish a God vision without supernatural faith. (Fear is the constant companion of all heroes of the faith)

We all love it when God gives us a promise—that's the easy part. Then the grueling process begins. I am going to identify **seven things that must be a part of accomplishing all Kingdom projects: (Place on the screen one at a time)**

- Identifying the partners...
- Securing the resources...
- Developing the strategies...
- Casting the vision...
- Managing the process...
- Motivating the people...
- Waiting on the miracles...

Working with God is exhilarating when these things happen. But keeping our faith at a level to accomplish the purpose of God is also warfare: (Warfare = Weariness) Here are some constants along the way that lend themselves to weariness:

- The obstacles...
- The waiting...
- The battles...
- The insults...
- The rejection...

- The disappointments...
- The casualties...

This process creates the desire to quit. We want to call in with illness and fatigue.

Zerubbabel and Joshua, the two men commissioned to rebuild Solomon's temple no doubt faced the phenomenon of weariness:

- The task was overwhelming...
- The cost was prohibitive...
- The workers were dismayed...
- The enemies were fierce...

These men of God struggled with intense discouragement as they looked at the ruins of Jerusalem.

They started the work in earnest, but they heard a familiar voice that whispered: *"You'll never finish this. God is going to abandon you in the middle of this project."*

Fortunately, just when Zerubbabel and Joshua were about to throw in the towel, the prophet Haggai showed up with a refreshing announcement. ***“'Now take courage, and work; for I am with you,' declares the Lord.”*** Haggai 2:4 - The Lord also promised He would see the building project to completion. ***“The latter glory of this house will be greater than the former. And in this place, I will give peace.”*** Haggai 2:9

Those powerful prophetic promises propelled Zerubbabel and Joshua forward. These words invigorated their weary faith and steeled their determination. Their passion was refueled. They returned to the work, even though it seemed impossible. In the end, God's house arose from an ash heap.

This is God's promise to all who are called to labor with Him. He does not tell you to begin something and then leave you halfway through it.

God is a wise builder and an expert craftsman. He is the Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end. He finishes what He starts. The question is, are we going to finish what God has started?

CONCLUSION:

The apostle Paul spoke to weary workers when he wrote, ***“For I am confident of this very thing, that He who began a good work in you will perfect it until the day of Christ Jesus.”***
Philippians 1:6 – (Speak this over each person in the room)

The Message Bible says it this way, ***“There has never been the slightest doubt in my mind that the God who started this great work in you would keep at it and bring it to a flourishing finish on the very day Christ Jesus appears.”***

I want to encourage you with the words of Haggai - ***“Take courage! The Lord is with you!”***

Regardless of what you lack, the Lord's mighty presence is all you need to finish the task. Hang on to Him and keep believing.